

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Billing & Invoice Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

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Company	Aether Wireless
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Overview

This policy establishes the billing and invoicing procedures for Aether Wireless customers. It covers the monthly invoice cycle, account status progression, payment methods, late fees, automated optimization reviews, and dispute resolution procedures. All staff in retail and customer care roles must apply these rules consistently to ensure accurate billing and timely payments.

Section 1: Monthly Invoicing

1.1 Invoice Cycle

Invoices are generated on the first business day of each billing cycle. Customers have a **15-day due window** from the invoice date to submit payment in full. Payment is considered on time if received by 11:59 PM ET on the due date.

1.2 Invoice Line Items

Each monthly invoice contains the following line item categories:

- **Plan Charge** – Base monthly cost of the customer's service plan
- **Taxes and Fees** – Regulatory fees and taxes totaling approximately **8–12%** of the plan charge, varying by state and locality
- **Add-Ons** – Optional services such as international calling, additional data packs, or streaming subscriptions
- **Device Installments** – Monthly payments for devices purchased on an installment plan
- **Protection Plans** – Costs for device protection, insurance, or warranty coverage
- **Service Fees** – Administrative fees for optional services (e.g., paper billing, expedited shipping)
- **Promo Credits** – Applied credits from promotional offers, displayed as negative line items

Section 2: Autopay and Payment Methods

2.1 Autopay Enrollment

Autopay is **enabled by default** for all new accounts. Customers may disable autopay at any time through the mobile app, online account management, or by contacting customer care.

2.2 Autopay Discount

Eligible customers receive a **\$5 per month discount** on the following plan tiers:

- Premium
- Unlimited
- Business

The discount applies to the primary line only and appears as a line item credit on each invoice.

2.3 Payment Retry Process

When a payment fails, Aether Wireless initiates an automated retry sequence:

- **Two retry attempts** are made over **5 business days** following the initial failure
- A **\$5 retry fee** is assessed for each failed retry attempt
- Customers are notified via SMS and email after each failed attempt

If both retries fail, the account moves to Past Due status (see Section 3).

Section 3: Account Status Ladder

The following status ladder governs account standing and service access:

Status	Criteria	Service Impact
Active	Current on all payments	Full service enabled
Past Due	15–30 days past due date	Service continues; reminders issued
Delinquent	More than 30 days past due	Service continues; final notice sent
Suspended	45 days past due	Service suspended; restoration fee applies
Prospect	New account, first payment pending	Limited service until first payment
Closed	90 days past due; no payment received	Account closed; referred to collections

Accounts in Suspended status may be restored upon payment of all outstanding balances plus a **\$25 restoration fee**.

Section 4: Late Fees and Administrative Charges

The following fees apply to accounts with delinquent payments or failed transactions:

Fee Type	Amount	Trigger Event
Late Fee	\$10	Payment not received within 15-day due window
Returned Payment Fee	\$25	Check, ACH, or card payment returned NSF
Chargeback Fee	\$35	Customer disputes a charge with their bank

Fee Type	Amount	Trigger Event
Paper Invoice Fee	\$2	Customer requests a paper invoice by mail

Late fees are assessed once per billing cycle and cap at **\$25** per month in total late fees.

Section 5: Automated Bill Optimization Reviews

Aether Wireless performs automated reviews of customer accounts to identify opportunities for cost savings. Reviews occur **monthly** and generate recommendations based on the following criteria:

5.1 Usage-Based Recommendations

Customers whose data or voice usage falls below **60%** of their plan allowance for **two consecutive billing cycles** receive a recommendation to:

- **Downgrade** to a lower-tier plan that better matches their usage
- **Consolidate lines** under a family plan to reduce overall cost
- **Enroll in autopay** to receive the \$5 monthly discount (if not already enrolled)
- **Remove unused add-ons** that appear on the invoice

Recommendations are delivered via the mobile app, online account portal, and email. Customers may accept or decline any recommendation without affecting their service.

Section 6: Billing Disputes

6.1 Dispute Window

Customers may dispute any charge on their invoice within **60 days** of the invoice date. Disputes submitted after the 60-day window are not guaranteed review, but Aether Wireless may accept them at its discretion.

6.2 Dispute Process

1. Customer contacts customer care by phone, chat, or in-store to initiate a dispute
2. A **case number** is issued to the customer for tracking purposes
3. The disputed amount is **held** from the customer's balance during review
4. Aether Wireless investigates and resolves the dispute within **5 business days**
5. If the dispute is approved, a **credit** is applied to the account within 5 business days
6. If the dispute is denied, the customer is notified with an explanation and the held amount is due

6.3 Credit Application

Approved credits appear as negative line items on the customer's next invoice. Credits are applied to the original payment method unless the customer requests an alternative.

Section 7: Annual Prepayment Discount

Customers who pay their entire annual service contract in advance receive a **10% discount** on the total annual cost. This discount applies to:

- Plan charges only

- Does not apply to taxes, fees, device installments, or add-ons

The discount is applied as a credit to the first invoice of the annual cycle. Annual prepayment is available for all plan tiers.

FAQs

Q: How long do I have to pay my invoice?

A: You have 15 days from the invoice date to submit payment in full. Payments must be received by 11:59 PM ET on the due date to avoid late fees.

Q: What happens if my autopay payment fails?

A: Aether Wireless will attempt to process your payment two more times over the next 5 business days. A \$5 retry fee applies to each failed attempt. If all retries fail, your account moves to Past Due status.

Q: Can I dispute a charge on my invoice after 60 days?

A: The standard dispute window is 60 days from the invoice date. Disputes submitted after this period may not be reviewed, though Aether Wireless reserves the right to accept late disputes on a case-by-case basis.

Q: How do I qualify for the 10% annual prepayment discount?

A: Pay your full annual service contract in advance to receive a 10% discount on plan charges. This discount is applied to your first invoice of the billing cycle and does not apply to taxes, fees, device installments, or add-ons.

Q: What is the automated bill optimization review?

A: This is a monthly review that analyzes your usage patterns. If you have used less than 60% of your plan allowance for two consecutive cycles, you may receive recommendations to downgrade your plan, consolidate family lines, enroll in autopay, or remove unused add-ons to save money.

Q: How do I restore service if my account is suspended?

A: Contact customer care to pay all outstanding balances plus a \$25 restoration fee. Service is typically restored within 24 hours of payment processing.

For billing questions, contact Customer Care at 1-800-AETHER or visit your local Aether Wireless retail store.